

A framework for analysing the problem space

- Are there problems with an existing product or user experience? If so, what are they?
- Why do you think there are problems?
- How do you think your proposed design ideas might overcome these?
- If you are designing for a new user experience how do you think your proposed design ideas support, change, or extend current ways of doing things?

Activity

- What are the assumptions and claims made about 3D TV?



Figure 2.2 A family watching 3D TV
Source: Andrey Popov/Shutterstock.com.

Assumptions: realistic or wish-list?

- People would not mind wearing the glasses that are needed to see in 3D in their living rooms – reasonable
- People would not mind paying a lot more for a new 3D-enabled TV screen – not reasonable
- People would really enjoy the enhanced clarity and color detail provided by 3D – reasonable
- People will be happy carrying around their own special glasses – reasonable only for a very select bunch of users

Benefits of conceptualising

- Orientation
 - enables design teams to ask specific questions about how the conceptual model will be understood
- Open-minded
 - prevents design teams from becoming narrowly focused early on
- Common ground
 - allows design teams to establish a set of commonly agreed terms

From problem space to design space

- Having a good understanding of the problem space can help inform the design space
 - e.g. what kind of interface, behavior, functionality to provide
- But before deciding upon these it is important to develop a conceptual model